

Ethics and Morality – AI Notes

These notes explain the concepts of ethics, morality, AI ethics, bias, privacy, inclusion, and responsible use of Artificial Intelligence with examples, real-world analogies, case studies, and brainstorming questions.

1. Ethics

Ethics are guiding principles that help us decide what is right or wrong. Ethics encourage fairness, honesty, responsibility, and safety in society.

Real-World Analogy

Traffic rules are similar to ethics. Following traffic signals keeps everyone safe. Similarly, ethics help people behave responsibly.

2. Morality

Morals are personal beliefs about good and bad behavior. They are influenced by family, religion, culture, and society.

3. Difference Between Ethics and Morals

Morals are personal beliefs, while ethics are structured principles or professional rules followed by organizations and society.

4. AI Ethics

AI ethics means developing and using Artificial Intelligence responsibly so that it remains fair, safe, and beneficial for people.

5. Human Rights in AI

AI systems should respect equality, freedom, and dignity of every individual. AI must not discriminate against people.

6. Bias in AI

Bias means unfair preference toward one group. AI becomes biased if the training data is unfair or incomplete.

7. Privacy in AI

Privacy means protecting personal information such as phone numbers, photos, passwords, and locations from misuse.

8. Inclusion in AI

AI should be accessible and useful for all people, including disabled individuals and economically weaker sections.

9. Ethical Scenarios

AI systems may create ethical challenges such as incorrect grading, unfair hiring, misuse of data, or spreading misinformation.

10. Responsible AI

Responsible AI is fair, transparent, safe, secure, and beneficial for society.

Important AI Ethics Principles

- Human Rights – AI must respect human equality and freedom.
- Bias – AI should avoid unfair treatment of people.
- Privacy – Personal information should remain secure.
- Inclusion – AI should help all sections of society equally.

Question Answers

1. Define ethics.

Ethics are principles that guide people to make fair and responsible decisions.

2. What are morals?

Morals are personal beliefs and values about correct and incorrect behavior.

3. State one difference between ethics and morals.

Ethics are formal guidelines, while morals are individual beliefs.

4. What is AI ethics?

AI ethics refers to the responsible and fair use of Artificial Intelligence systems.

5. What is bias in AI?

Bias in AI means unfair preference shown by AI systems because of biased training data.

6. Why is data privacy important?

Data privacy protects personal information from unauthorized access or misuse.

7. What is inclusion in AI?

Inclusion ensures that AI systems are useful and accessible to all people equally.

8. Why should AI follow human rights?

AI should follow human rights to prevent discrimination and protect human dignity.

9. How can AI become unethical?

AI becomes unethical when it spreads misinformation, violates privacy, or treats people unfairly.

10. Give one example of ethical AI.

A medical AI system that protects patient records and treats all patients equally is an example of ethical AI.

Application-Based Brainstorming Questions

1. Suppose a school installs AI cameras to monitor students during exams. What ethical problems may arise? Suggest solutions.
2. If an AI system predicts that certain students may perform poorly in exams, should teachers treat them differently? Why or why not?
3. A company uses AI to hire employees, but most selected candidates belong to one gender. What could be the reason behind this?
4. Should AI systems be allowed to make important decisions without human involvement? Explain with examples.
5. Imagine an AI app that tracks students' locations all day for safety purposes. Would this improve safety or reduce privacy? Discuss.
6. If AI can replace workers in factories, what should governments and people do to reduce unemployment?
7. A social media AI keeps recommending violent videos because a user watched one such video earlier. Is this ethical? Why?
8. How can schools use AI responsibly without harming students' creativity and independent thinking?
9. If AI systems become more intelligent than humans in future, what ethical rules should be created today?
10. Should children below a certain age have limited access to AI tools? Give reasons for your answer.

Case Study Based Questions

Case Study 1: AI Essay Grading

A school started using an AI-based system to check essays. Many students complained that creative answers were receiving lower marks than simple answers.

Questions:

1. What ethical issue is visible in this case?
2. Why might the AI system fail to grade correctly?
3. How can the school improve the fairness of the system?
4. Should teachers completely depend on AI for grading? Why?

Case Study 2: Online Shopping Recommendations

An online shopping app collects user data such as search history, location, and favorite products to recommend items. Some users feel uncomfortable because the app seems to know too much about them.

Questions:

1. Which AI ethics principle is involved in this situation?
2. How can user privacy be protected?
3. Should companies ask permission before collecting personal data?
4. What could happen if such data is leaked?

Case Study 3: AI Recruitment Tool

A company used an AI recruitment tool to select employees. Later, it was discovered that the AI was rejecting resumes from women more frequently than men.

Questions:

1. What ethical issue is present in this case?
2. How can biased data affect AI decisions?
3. Suggest ways to reduce AI bias in recruitment systems.
4. Why is fairness important in AI hiring tools?